Benjamin Davies

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Education

PhD in Economics, Stanford University, 2020–27 (expected).
BSc(Hons, 1st class) in Economics and Mathematics, University of Canterbury, 2014–17.

Publications

"Persistence, patience and costly information acquisition," *Economics Letters*, 2026.
"Gender sorting among economists: Evidence from the NBER," *Economics Letters*, 2022.
"COVID-19, lockdown and two-sided uncertainty" (with Arthur Grimes), *New Zealand Economic Papers*, 2022.
"Research funding and collaboration" (with Jason Gush, Shaun C. Hendy, and Adam B. Jaffe), *Research Policy*, 2022.
"Relatedness, complexity and local growth" (with David C. Maré), *Regional Studies*, 2021.

Working Papers

"Course design in the age of AI," 2026.
"The value of conceptual knowledge" (with Anirudh Sankar), 2026.
"How mechanistic explanations reshape learning and behavior: Evidence from a fertilizer choice experiment in Eastern Uganda" (with Anirudh Sankar, Robert Dulin, Vesall Nourani, Jess Rudder, Abraham Salomon, and Godfrey Taulya), 2026.

Awards

SIEPR Dissertation Fellowship, 2026.
William Georgetti Scholarship (for "best brains" in New Zealand), 2020.
Seamus Hogan Memorial Prize (for best thesis in economics at Canterbury), 2017.
Cook Memorial Prize (for top honors mathematics student at Canterbury), 2017.
Sir Frank Holmes Prize (for top undergraduate economics student in New Zealand), 2016.

Research and Professional Experience

Research Assistant to Matthew Jackson, Stanford University, 2021–22.
Research Analyst, Motu Economic and Public Policy Research, 2018–20.
Actuarial Consulting Intern, PwC, 2015–16.

Teaching Experience

Stanford University (as Teaching Assistant): Behavioral Economics; Decision Modeling and Information; Finance, Corporations and Society; Foundations of Finance; Junior Honors Seminar (on thesis writing); Personal Finance.
University of Canterbury (as TA): Financial Economics; Intermediate Microeconomics; Microeconomic Theory.

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